

1 Merging Serial Numbers

Usage

Merging serial numbers allows for different material components listed by serial numbers to be combined specifically into one new component part. The serial number of the new component part may be the number of one of the incorporated serial numbers or assigned anew.

Process of merging serial numbers

Merging serial numbers is based on the management of serial numbers incorporated in [merged batches](#) registered as input batches. Incorporated serial numbers are assigned based on the serial numbers included in these merged batches.

This process also outputs a serial number. There are two strategies to get the serial number:

- An integrated serial number is continued keeping the ID
The indicator "superordinate serial number" at the component specifies which one of the incorporated components includes the serial number ID that is to be continued. These components and/or their serial numbers are designated as superordinate serial numbers.

For each operation only one component can be assigned the flag "superordinate serial number".

- A new serial number is assigned
If no component is identified as superordinate, the new serial number to be assigned can either be specified or the system assigns a number automatically.

If a merged batch with assigned serial numbers is finished, the system updates data and generates new documents in the form of log records and goods movements.

Posting of serial numbers

Transfer of data from the operation

This data is taken over from the running operation and transferred to the merged batch and the assigned serial numbers:

- Material and material name
- Material type

Transfer of entered data to serial numbers and the merged batch

The machine, producing operation, person performing the posting, material buffer and the transport unit are transferred to the merged batch and the serial numbers included in the merged batch.

Any comment that might be entered is transferred to the merged batch as additional information on the batch.

The status of the merged batch and serial numbers is set subject to the specified quality/class of the output batch:

Selected class	Assigned batch status	Reason accepted
Yield	Free	No
Scrap	Locked	Yes
Rework	Free	Yes
Open quantity	Free	Yes

Batch attributes collected in relation to the merged batch are transferred to the merged batch as batch attributes.

Batch attributes collected in relation to the serial number are transferred to serial numbers as batch attributes.

Document links collected in relation to the merged batch are transferred to the merged batch as document links.

Document links collected in relation to the serial number are transferred to serial numbers as document links.

Quantities of the merged batch

The generated merged batch includes the total quantities of the serial numbers assigned to the merged batch.

The number of assigned serial numbers is defined for the merged batch as number of individual batches.

Activities for serial numbers

New batches with a new, internal HYDRA batch number are generated for the serial numbers included in the merged batch (for further details on this procedure, please see section [HYDRA batch number vs. serial number](#)) and the preceding batches are assigned the "processed" status.

Generation of ADE log records

An H record is generated for the merged batch. This one includes the quantity(ies) of the merged batch, which in turn result(s) from the quantities of the assigned serial numbers. The batch number of the merged batch is stored at the H record.

Separate log records are not generated for serial numbers.

Generation of goods movements

The generation of goods movements can be controlled individually for consumptions as well as for the output material on the level of serial numbers and merged batches.

Consequently, it is possible to adjust the upload of these goods movements to the conditions of the relevant ERP system.

Details on how to configure goods movements can be found in [configuration instructions for the collection of serial numbers](#).

Tracing

Tracing information is updated for the merged batch and serial numbers in the system:

- The generated merged batch is connected with all integrated input batches logged on at the time of logging the merged batch on (by logging the OP on or by completing a merged batch beforehand) or that have been logged on since then.
- The serial numbers included in the merged batch are also connected with all integrated input batches logged on at the time of logging the merged batch on (by logging the OP on or by completing a merged batch beforehand) or that have been logged on since then.

[Establishing connections](#) between serial numbers and the input batch can be disabled if required.